

The Unclosable: Contingent Reality

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31 January 2026

Abstract

This paper identifies a class of remainder that cannot be eliminated by admissibility- and standing-preserving closure: contingent particulars. Contingency is not treated as an ontological primitive, nor as a defect in explanation. It is fixed as a limit on derivation: admissible and witnessable facts that cannot be derived from admissibility constraints alone. Attempts to “close” contingency necessarily extend necessity beyond its licensed scope, converting instance-level facts into anchor-level claims and thereby collapsing standing. The result blocks three recurrent illicit strategies—reduction, inflation (including probabilistic surrogates), and dismissal—while preserving open inquiry wherever admissible witnessing and scope evolution remain possible.

1 Scope Fixation

This paper permits the following classes of questions:

- What classes of facts cannot be closed by admissibility or standing?
- Where does derivability terminate without incoherence?
- What distinguishes structural necessity from instance-level particularity?

The following questions are forbidden:

- Why this particular instance rather than another?
- What mechanism selected these particulars?
- Can contingency be reduced, eliminated, or explained away?

This paper classifies *limits on derivation*. It does not introduce mechanisms, dynamics, or metaphysical accounts.

2 Role Assignment

Anchors

- Admissibility
- Standing
- Non-derivability of anchors
- Separation of necessity and contingency as a derivational boundary

Anchors are fixed. Any attempt to treat contingency as an explainer, primitive, or deficit constitutes illicit anchor motion.

Tensors

- Necessity/contingency boundary
- Instance-selection limits
- Scope termination of derivation

Tensors mark where derivation halts without failure.

Skin

- “Initial conditions” language
- Appeals to chance, randomness, or brute fact
- Rhetorical discomfort with non-derivability

Skin elements are non-authoritative and diagnostically secondary.

3 Structural Analysis

Closure eliminates illicit inferential moves. It does not exhaust the space of admissible facts.

A fact is **contingent** if it is:

- admissible,
- witnessable,
- and not derivable from admissibility constraints alone.

Contingency is not ontological. It is a **limit on derivation**.

Any attempt to eliminate contingency requires converting instance-level facts into anchor-level necessities. This violates admissibility and collapses standing by demanding explanation where none is permitted.

Three recurrent illicit strategies are thereby closed:

1. **Reduction:** reclassifying particulars as disguised necessities.
2. **Inflation:** introducing hidden variables, meta-laws, or probabilistic surrogates to force derivation.
3. **Dismissal:** treating underivable facts as epistemic failure rather than structural remainder.

All three are structurally identical: they attempt to extend necessity beyond its licensed scope.

4 Failure and Closure Results

This paper closes the following illicit moves:

1. **“A complete framework should derive all particulars.”** Derivability is bounded by admissibility; particulars exceed that boundary.
2. **“What is not derivable is merely not yet understood.”** This treats permanent derivation limits as provisional ignorance and reopens anchor motion.
3. **“Probability or randomness can close contingency.”** Probabilistic restatement does not derive particulars; it only redescribes non-derivability and therefore fails as closure.
4. **“Initial conditions are explanatory defects.”** Instance selectors are not explanations and cannot be promoted to necessity without standing collapse.

Each failure attempts to convert derivational limits into explanatory obligations.

5 Non-Generative Termination

No mechanisms of instance selection are introduced. No probabilistic, stochastic, or metaphysical accounts are proposed. No future derivations are implied.

The paper terminates with the invariant:

Contingent reality is unclosable because derivation is bounded. Attempts to close contingency convert admissibility into ontology and fail.